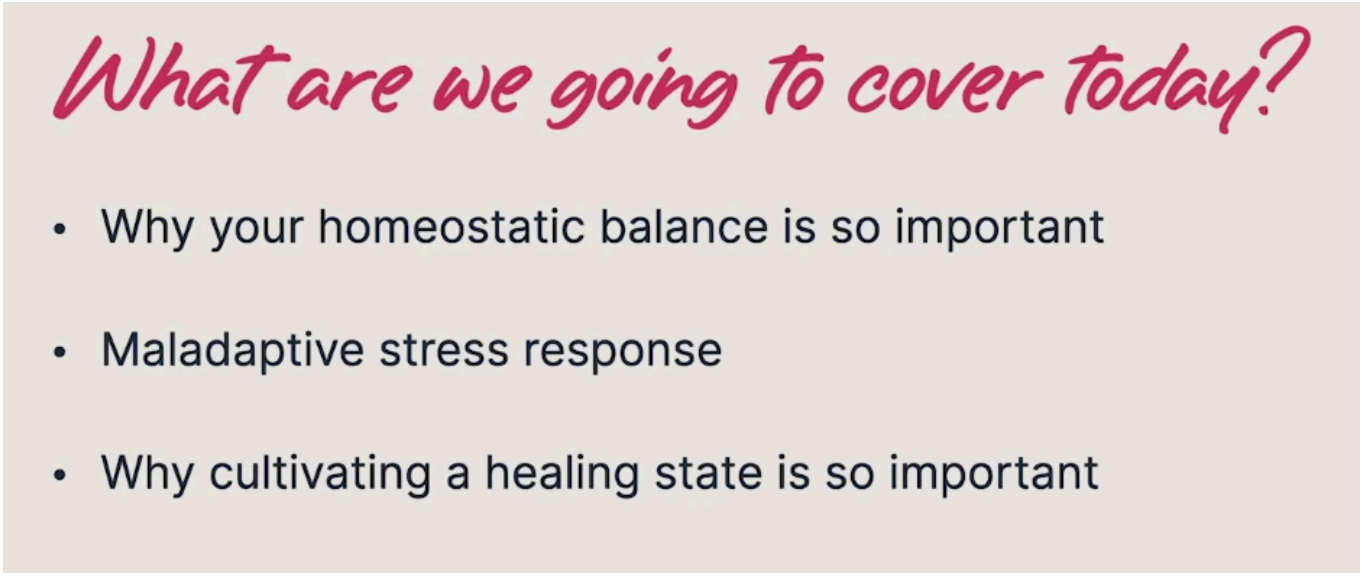
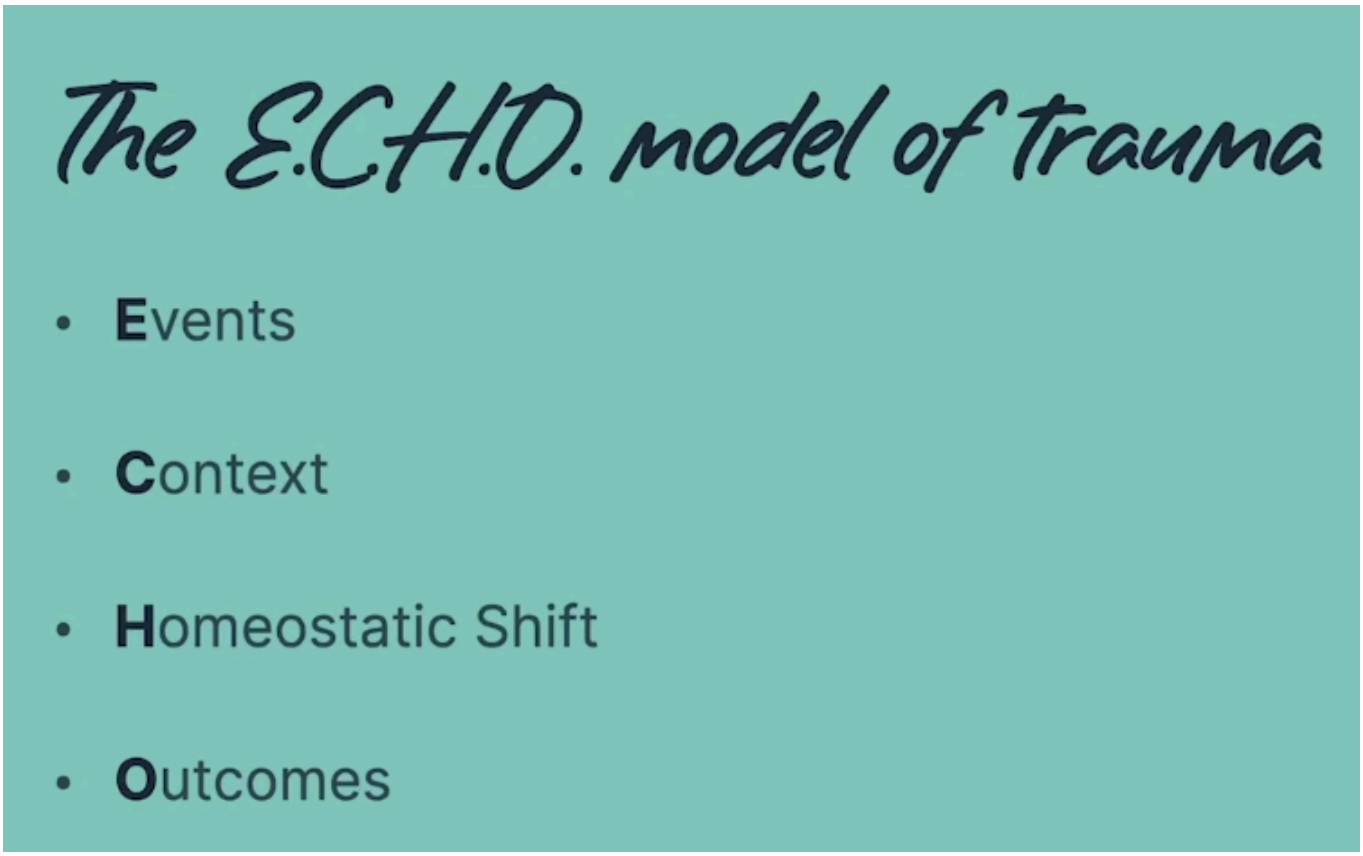
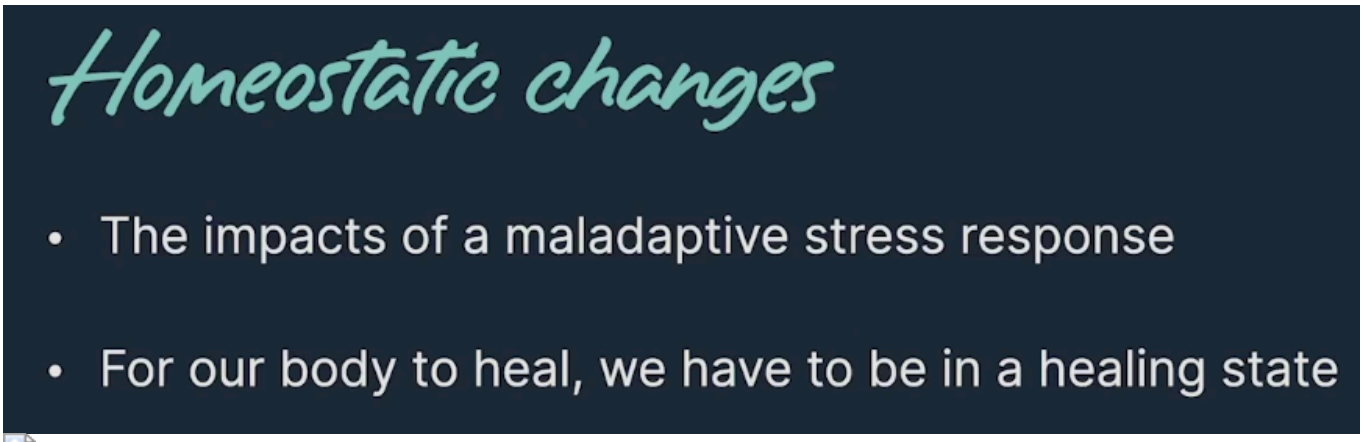
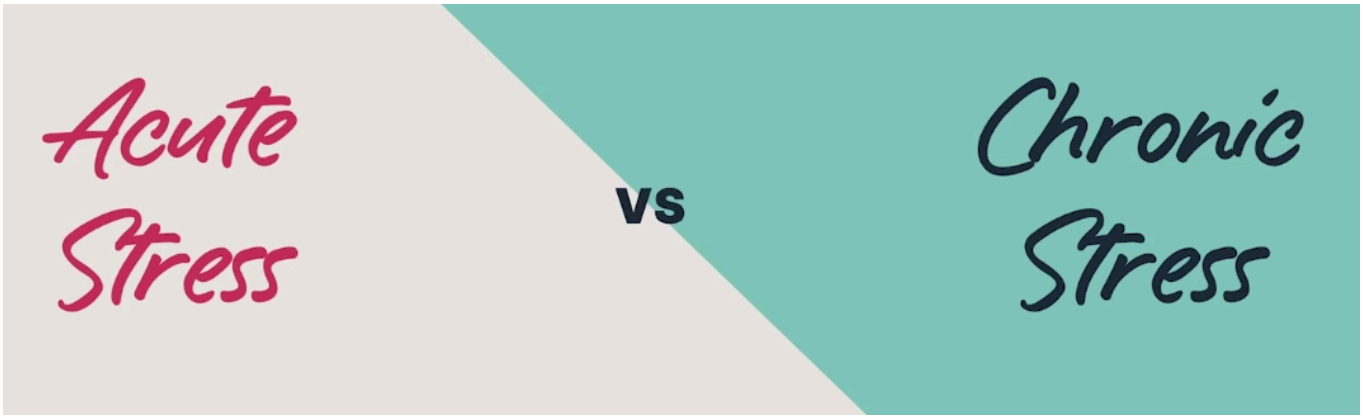
Decode Your Trauma Seminar - Day 4 Notes by Andy







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FIGHT FLIGHT FREEZE

SHUTDOWN

FAWN - PEOPLE PLEASING - CONTROL IT

NEED ADAPTIVE RESPONSE

CUT OF TEA - SELF REGULATE

SEE SAPULSKY

CHRONIC STRESS - DOESN'T GO AWAY

PERCEPTION OF THREAD DOESNT GO AWAY
MALADAPTED

Are you like a frog in boiling water?

The temperature keeps rising,
but you keep normalizing and don't notice?



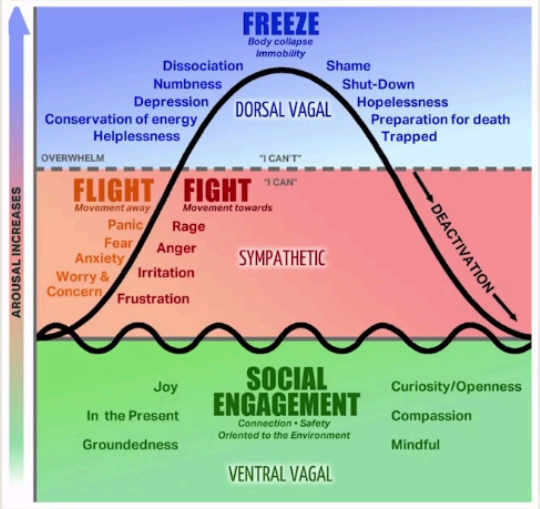
GRADUAL CHANGE TO WATER GETTING HOTTER - DO NOT REACT

EMPATH FEELING WHAT OTHERS FEEL

Introducing Polyvagal Theory

Dr. Stephen Porges is a Professor of Psychiatry at the University of North Carolina and the creator of Polyvagal Theory.

Polyvagal theory serves to identify the relationship between visceral experiences and the vagus nerve's control of the heart, lungs, and digestive tract.





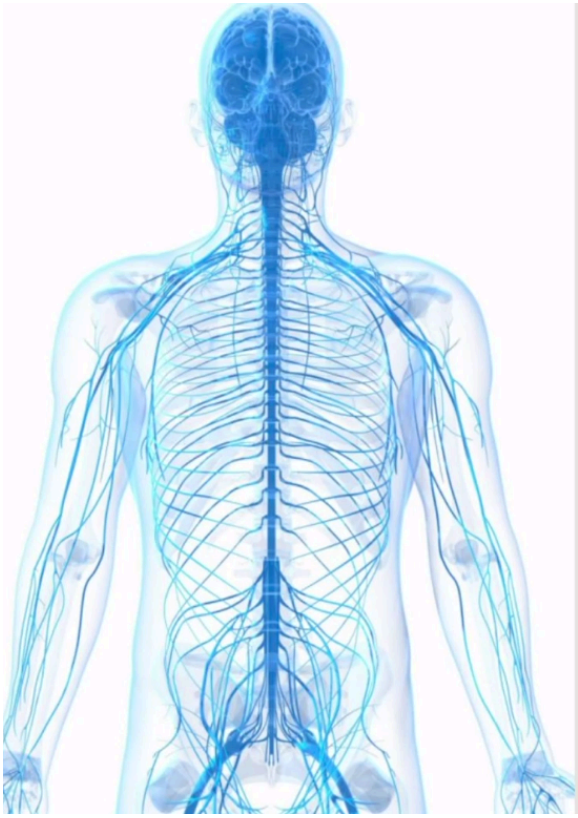
The Vagus Nerve

- “Vagus" comes from the Latin term for "wandering."
- This is because the vagus nerve wanders from the brain into organs in the neck, chest, and abdomen.
- The vagus nerve is how our brain connects to the rest of our body

The paths of the vagus nerve

- **Ventral vagal:** responds to cues of safety and supports feeling of being safely engaged and socially connected.
- **Dorsal vagal:** responds to cues of extreme danger – takes us out of connection, out of of awareness, and into a protective collapse





Neuroception

Neuroception is detection without awareness – it is how our body responds to stress before we have been noticed

Examples:

- Changing environment and feel system is stress
- Bouncing boundaries in recovery from ME/CFS
- Being around people we don't feel safe with activates system

DETECTION WITTHOUT AWARENESS

3 Levels of Nervous System



Safe and social:
Ventral vagal



Fight or flight:
Sympathetic



Freeze:
Dorsal vagal

HEALING STATE
STATE OF ACTIVATION
SHUTDOWN - CAN TAKE A LOT OF ENERY TO MAINTAIN

Safe and social

- We seek connection
- We send cues of safety and invitations to come into connection through the signals of tone of voice, facial expression, the tilt of the head
- We respond positively to the same in others
- We sense whether others are safe to approach and signal that we are friend not foe





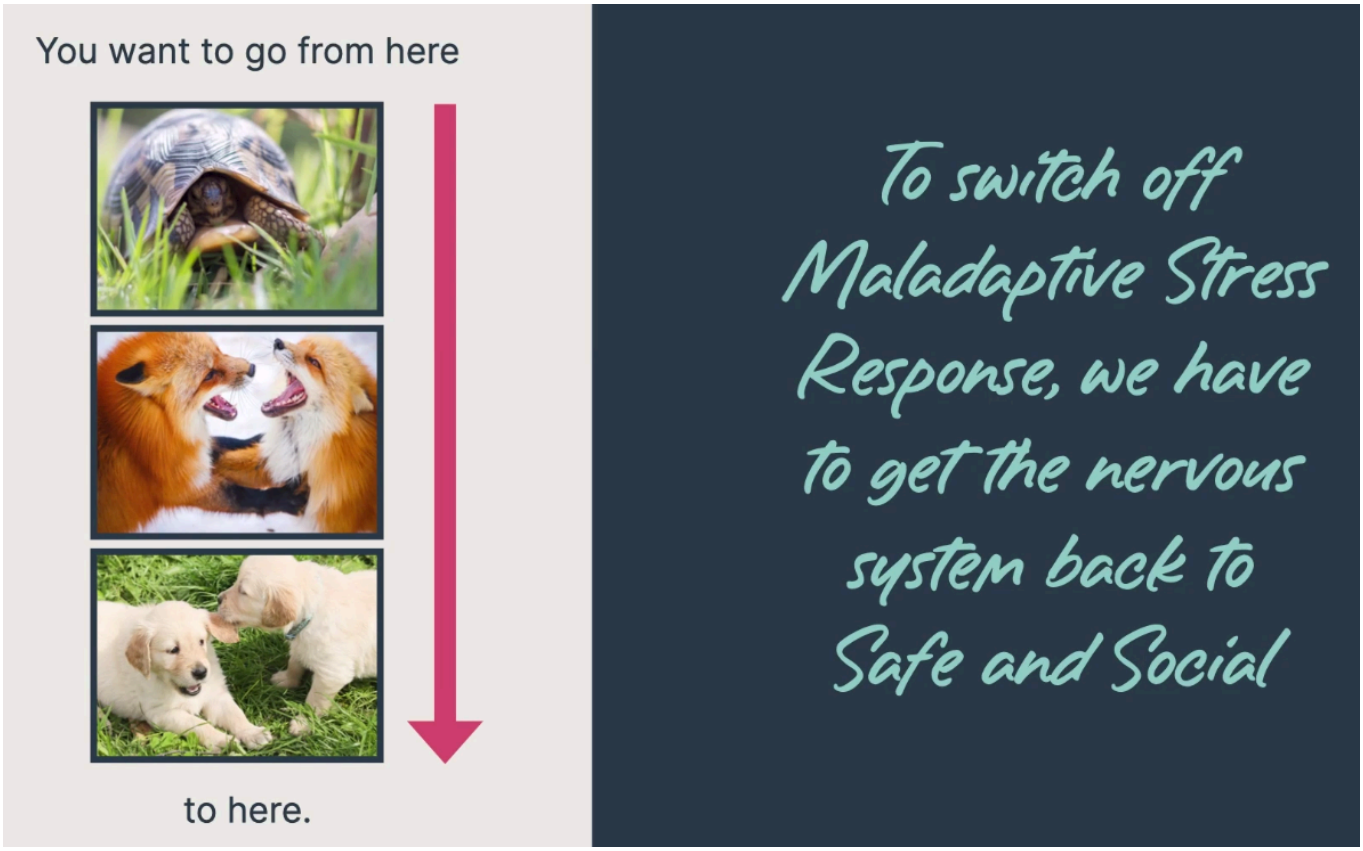
Fight or flight

- We are primed for action and our system is literally deciding whether to fight or run
- Body pumps adrenaline and cortisol
- In this state we misread cues – neutral faces appear angry, neutral is experienced as dangerous

NEUTRAL PERCEIVED AS DANGEROUS
SEE THRU OUR OWN FILTER
CONFIRMATION BIAS - EVEN IF NOT THERE
SUBJECTIVE TRUTH
GET STUCK



MITOCHONTRIA

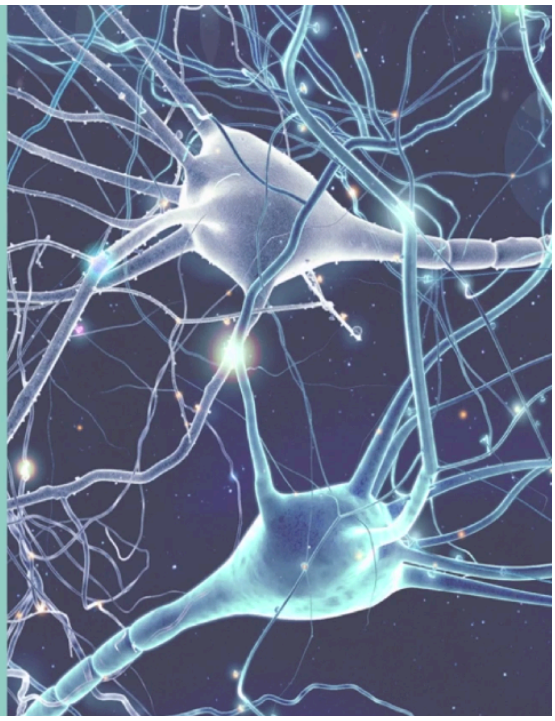


CAN SHAKE WHEN WE PROCESS THE TRAUMA

Rating your nervous system

How would you rate your nervous system now?

8-10	Freeze/shutdown
4-7	Fight or flight
1-3	Safe and social/healing state



Immobilization – Freeze

10 Completely numb and shut down
9 Disconnected and feelings hard to access
8 Demotivated and feeling stuck

Mobilization – Fight or Flight

7 Intense anxiety moving into feeling of resignation
6 Mind and body pumping with adrenaline and feeling wired
5 Mind racing, body feeling tense, and trying to think one's way to a feeling of safety
4 Feeling agitated and finding it hard to completely relax

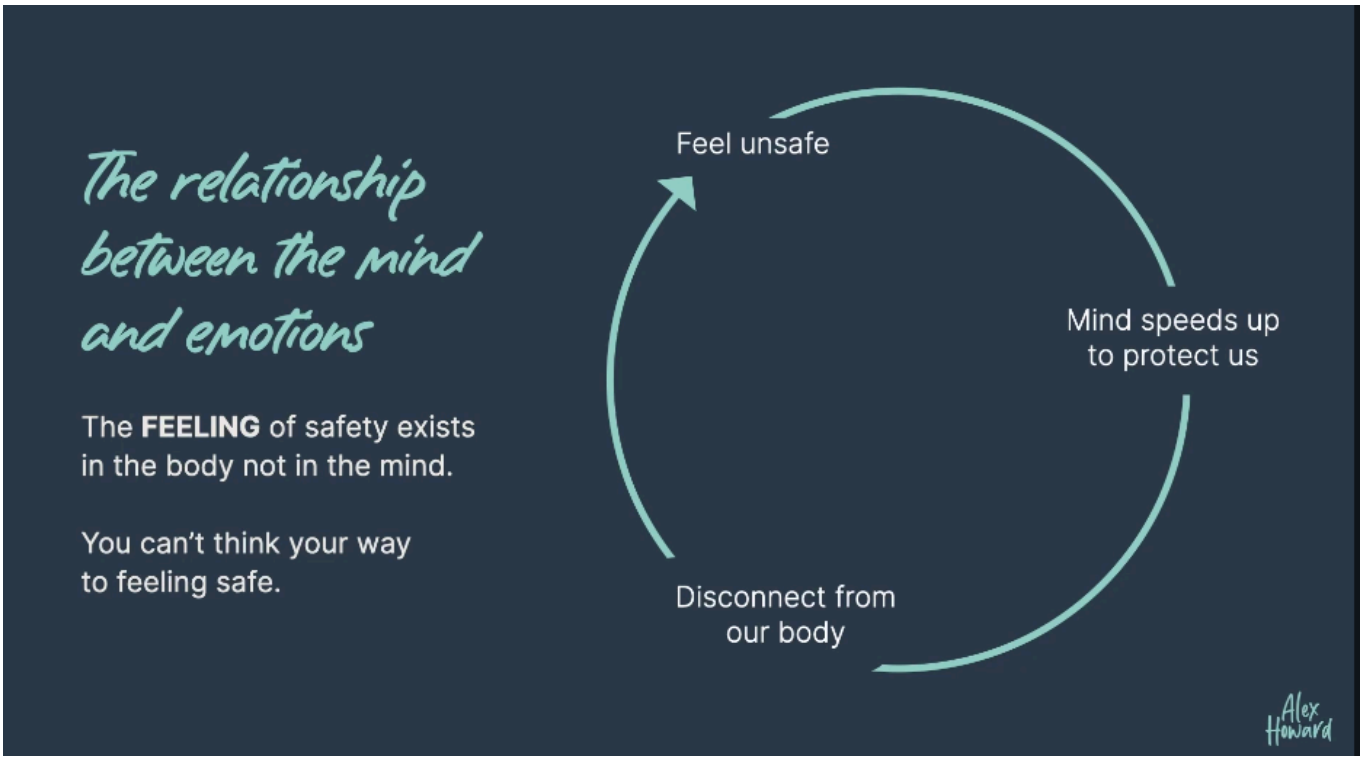
Socialization – Healing State

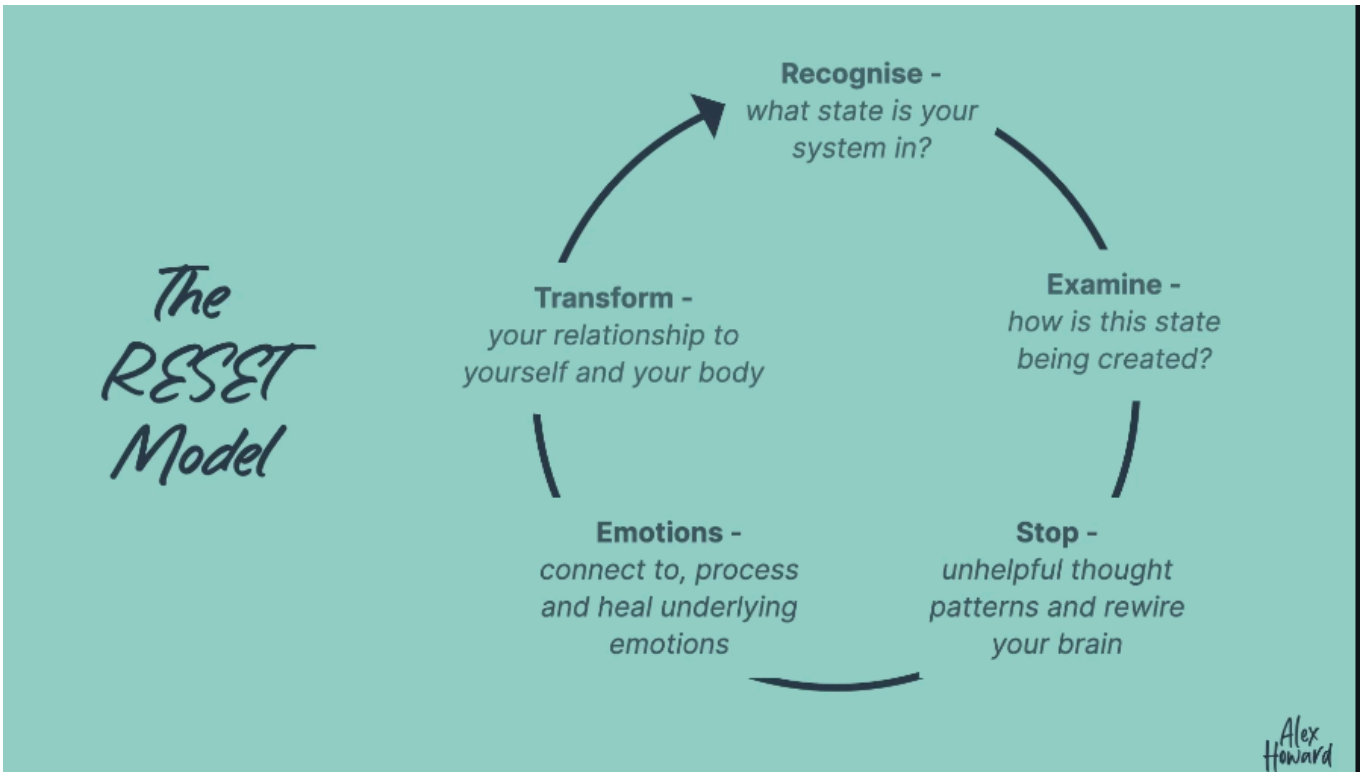
3 Neutral feeling, but able to relax and enjoy the moment
2 Calm and relaxed and enjoying the company of others
1 Deep sense of relaxation and feeling safe within oneself

For the next 3 days, please record your score at the following points in the day:

Upon waking			
Mid-morning			
Lunchtime			
Mid-afternoon			
Early evening			
Before bed			

Please remember, that the good news is that **however much our homeostasis might have shifted, we can learn to RESET our system.**







LEARN SELF-REGULATION
STOP LOOKING FOR SALVATION FROM THE OUTSIDE